

Recon-ng Lab Report: Domain Reconnaissance on facebook.com

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Analyst: Alex

Location: Ngecha Tigoni Ward, Kiambu County, Kenya

Objective

To perform passive reconnaissance on the domain facebook.com using Recon-ng modules, focusing on WHOIS contact harvesting and host discovery via HackerTarget.

Tools & Environment

- Workspace: whois_recon
- Modules Used:
 - recon/domains-contacts/whois_pocs
 - recon/domains-hosts/hackertarget

Module 1: Whois POC Harvester

Path: recon/domains-contacts/whois_pocs

Function: Queries ARIN WHOIS RWS to extract Points of Contact (POCs) for the target domain.

Execution Steps

- Installed and loaded the module.
- Set SOURCE to facebook.com.
- Ran the module successfully.

Results

Two WHOIS contacts were discovered:

- Brandon Stout
- Email: bstout@facebook.com
- Region: Chicago, IL
- Title: Whois contact
- Operations
- Email: domain@facebook.com
- Region: Menlo Park, CA
- Title: Whois contact

These entries were added to the contacts table in the workspace.

Module 2: HackerTarget Host Lookup

Path: recon/domains-hosts/hackertarget

Function: Uses HackerTarget.com API to discover hostnames and IP addresses associated with the domain.

Execution Steps

- Installed and loaded the module.
- Set SOURCE to facebook.com.
- Ran the module successfully.

Results

One host was identified:

- Host: facebook.com
- IP Address: 57.144.174.1
- Country/Region/Coordinates: Not returned

The result was stored in the hosts table.

Observations

- Module installation and loading required careful attention to syntax (e.g., correcting typos like hacjertarget).
- WHOIS data provided useful contact leads for potential social engineering or organizational mapping.
- HackerTarget returned minimal data, likely due to API limitations or domain protection.

Conclusion

The reconnaissance process successfully harvested WHOIS contacts and host data for facebook.com. These findings can be used to enrich further OSINT efforts, map infrastructure, or simulate adversarial targeting in a controlled lab environment.

My Lab Demos

```
Home File System Trash
[*] No modules enabled/installed.

recon-ng][default] > whois_recon
[!] Invalid command: whois_recon.
recon-ng][default] > workspaces create whois_recon
recon-ng][whois_recon] > marketplace search whois
[*] Searching module index for 'whois' ...

+-----+
|      |      |      |      |      |      |      |      |
|      | D | K |      |      |      |      |      |
+-----+
| recon/companies-domains/viewdns_reverse_whois | 1.1 | not installed | 2021-08-24 |
| recon/companies-multi/whois_miner | 1.1 | not installed | 2019-10-15 |
| recon/domains-companies/whoxy_whois | 1.1 | not installed | 2020-06-24 |
| recon/domains-contacts/whois_pocs | 1.0 | not installed | 2019-06-24 |
| recon/netblocks-companies/whois_orgs | 1.0 | not installed | 2019-06-24 |
+-----+

D = Has dependencies. See info for details.
K = Requires keys. See info for details.

recon-ng][whois_recon] > marketplace install recon/domains-contacts/whois_pocs
[*] Module installed: recon/domains-contacts/whois_pocs
[*] Reloading modules ...
recon-ng][whois_recon] > modules load recon/domains-caontacts/whois_pocs
[!] Invalid module name.
```

View image

SOURCE => facebook.com
[recon-ng][whois_recon][whois_pocs] > info

Name: Whois POC Harvester
Author: Tim Tomes (@lanmaster53)
Version: 1.0

Description:
Uses the ARIN Whois RWS to harvest POC data from whois queries for the given domain. Updates the 'contacts' table with the results.

Options:

Name	Current Value	Required	Description
SOURCE	facebook.com	yes	source of input (see 'info' for details)

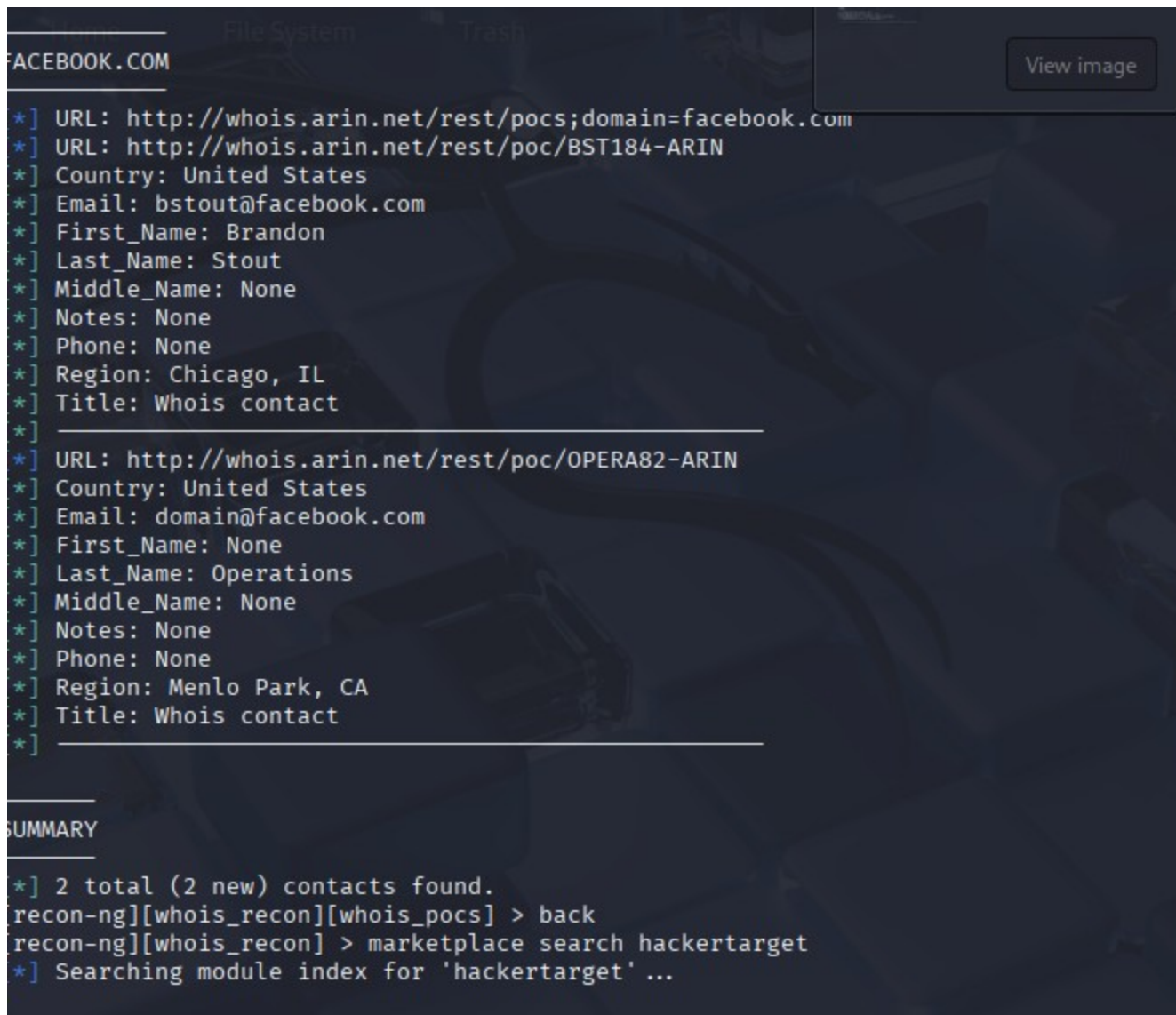
Source Options:

default	SELECT DISTINCT domain FROM domains WHERE domain IS NOT NULL
<string>	string representing a single input
<path>	path to a file containing a list of inputs
query <sql>	database query returning one column of inputs

[recon-ng][whois_recon][whois_pocs] > run

FACEBOOK.COM

```
[*] URL: http://whois.arin.net/rest/pocs;domain=facebook.com
[*] URL: http://whois.arin.net/rest/poc/BST184-ARIN
[*] Country: United States
[*] Email: bstout@facebook.com
[*] First_Name: Brandon
[*] Last_Name: Stout
[*] Middle_Name: None
[*] Notes: None
[*] Phone: None
```



```
recon-ng[whois_recon] > marketplace search hackertarget
[*] Searching module index for 'hackertarget' ...
```

```
+-----+
+           Path           | Version | Status   | Updated   | D |
+-----+
+ recon/domains-hosts/hackertarget | 1.1     | not installed | 2020-05-17 |   |
+-----+
```

D = Has dependencies. See info for details.
K = Requires keys. See info for details.

```
recon-ng[whois_recon] > marketplace install recon/domains-hosts/hackjertarget
!] Invalid module path.
recon-ng[whois_recon] > marketplace install recon/domains-hosts/hackertarget
*] Module installed: recon/domains-hosts/hackertarget
*] Reloading modules ...
```


File Actions Edit View Help

```
[recon-ng][whois_recon] > modules load recon/domains-hosts
```

```
[recon-ng][whois_recon][hackertarget] > set SOURCE facebook.com
```

```
[!] Invalid command: set SOURCE facebook.com.
```

```
[recon-ng][whois_recon][hackertarget] > options set SOURCE
```

```
SOURCE => facebook.com
```

```
[recon-ng][whois_recon][hackertarget] > info
```

```
Name: HackerTarget Lookup
Author: Michael Henriksen (@michenriksen)
Version: 1.1
```

Description:

Uses the HackerTarget.com API to find host names. Updates the 'hosts' table with the results.

Options:

Name	Current Value	Required	Description
SOURCE	facebook.com	yes	source of input (see 'info' for details)

Source Options:

default	SELECT DISTINCT domain FROM domains WHERE domain IS NOT NULL
<string>	string representing a single input
<path>	path to a file containing a list of inputs
query <sql>	database query returning one column of inputs

```
[recon-ng][whois_recon][hackertarget] > run
```

FACEBOOK.COM

```
[*] Country: None
[*] Host: facebook.com
[*] Ip_Address: 57.144.174.1
[*] Latitude: None
[*] Longitude: None
[*] Notes: None
```

Screenshot taken

View image

```
[*] Country: None
[*] Host: facebook.com
[*] Ip_Address: 57.144.174.1
[*] Latitude: None
[*] Longitude: None
[*] Notes: None
[*] Region: None
[*] _____
[*] Country: None
[*] Host: alf.facebook.com
[*] Ip_Address: 192.168.16.27
[*] Latitude: None
[*] Longitude: None
[*] Notes: None
[*] Region: None
[*] _____
```